Taylor — DFS Cards Project Sheet

Sep 28, 2026 · @Duane

The role

Taylor has been with Duane for six years and helped build the headshot studio. Now she's helping build DFS Cards to $50k a month. Her main focus is the website and social media; buying comes in alongside as she learns the system.

- **What she owns:** dfscards.com, social media, and a growing share of lot sourcing.
- **Decided together:** pricing strategy, big buys, and changes to CardPulse.
- **Time:** a set weekly block for cards, separate from studio ops. Hours per week to settle before week 1.

Claude is her writing and research partner throughout: drafting posts, product copy, and comp checks. She reviews and posts; Claude doesn't publish anything on its own.

Workstream 1 — dfscards.com

Goal: turn dfscards.com from a default Shopify theme into a store that looks as serious as the eBay feedback says it is. Right now it has three menu links (Home, Catalog, Contact), featured cards priced $1.57–$4.99, no social links, no reviews, and no about page.

Study these two before touching anything. Both are Shopify stores, so anything they do is buildable on ours.

	CardCollector2	Wayne Collection	dfscards.com today
Menu	Packs & Boxes, Single Cards, Supplies, Whatnot, Merch, Memorabilia, About/FAQ	Value Bins, Boxes & Packs, Supplies, Merch, Gift Cards, NFL Teams, Reviews, Info	Home, Catalog, Contact
How cards are sorted	By sport, by format, plus a High-End Singles tier	By price bin ($1/$2/$3/$5), by team, slabs separate	By sport only

	CardCollector2	Wayne Collection	dfscards.com today
Homepage sections	Bestsellers, Featured Singles, Just Added, per-sport rows	Value Bins, Newly Listed, Slabs, Boxes	8 cheap featured cards, 6 sport tiles
Trust	Store address + hours, ships in 1–2 days, FAQ	685 on-site reviews, packaging shown	None
Email hook	"Never Miss A Sale!"	"Be The First To Know About New Drops"	"Subscribe to our emails"
Social	X, FB, IG, TikTok, YouTube, eBay, Whatnot	IG, TikTok, YouTube	None

What to borrow: Wayne's price bins with multi-card discounts (fits our low-end clearance), CardCollector2's High-End Singles tier (fits the $50+ push), and both stores' Just Added row plus visible trust signals.

Tasks

- [ ] Screenshot both reference homepages and 2 product pages each; mark what to copy
- [ ] New menu: Singles by sport, High-End ($50+), Value Bins, Graded, About, FAQ
- [ ] Homepage: hero using the navy crest / charcoal-platinum branding, High-End row, Just Added row, Value Bins row
- [ ] Swap featured cards to $20+ inventory — lead with the best cards, not the cheapest
- [ ] Add trust block: 1,144+ eBay feedback, ships from Scottsdale, UPS insured on $20+
- [ ] Link Instagram @duanefurlongcards and the eBay store in header and footer
- [ ] Write About and FAQ pages with Claude (shipping, returns, combined shipping, buying collections)
- [ ] Rewrite the email signup line — give a reason to subscribe
- [ ] Show Duane a before/after before publishing

Workstream 2 — Social media

Goal: steady posting that sells cards directly on Instagram and Facebook — lower fees than eBay — and pushes traffic to dfscards.com. Right now posts are fronts only and irregular.

Weekly posting plan (starting point — adjust after 4 weeks)

Day	Post	Goal
Mon	New arrivals — 3–5 best cards from the week, front + back	Drive site visits
Wed	One "card of the week" with the story (player, parallel, print run)	Build following
Fri	Weekend deal or bundle (Value Bin, lot) with price in caption	Direct sales
Sun	Behind the scenes — lot opening, packing an order, the photo setup	Trust

How to write posts with Claude

1. Give Claude the card photo and details (year, set, player, parallel, serial #, price).
2. Ask for a caption in the DFS voice: short, dry, confident, no hype words.
3. Ask for 8–12 hashtags split between sport, player, team, and set.
4. Review, trim, post. Save the good captions in one shared note so the voice stays consistent.

Rules

- Every post shows price or says "DM for price" — no guessing games.
- Front and back on every card over $20.
- DM sales: payment before shipping, same shipping tiers as eBay.
- Follow the existing social media conduct guide.

Tasks

- [ ] Audit @duanefurlongcards: what's there, what performed
- [ ] Set up a DFS Cards Facebook page if one doesn't exist; link it to Instagram
- [ ] Build a 2-week content calendar with Claude and get Duane's sign-off
- [ ] Make 3 reusable post templates (new arrival, card of the week, deal) in the navy/charcoal branding
- [ ] Track weekly: followers, DMs, sales from social

Workstream 3 — Learning to buy cards

Goal: Taylor can find, vet, and price a lot to Duane's rules, then buy on her own. Every rule below is already how Duane buys — she's learning his system, not inventing one.

The rules

- Buy lots in the **$100–500** range, ideally **20–40 cards**. Each card takes ~3.6 minutes to list and ship, so 500 cards is ~30 hours of work.
- Skip anything that sells under $10 — it moves at 2.2% a month.
- Want: numbered parallels (/99 or lower), on-card autos, PSA 9–10 slabs, current-year rookies, football in season.
- Reject: mostly base/commons, no parallels or autos, "500 card" bulk counts, or a seller who won't show a checklist.
- Comp off **Buy It Now sold** listings, not auctions.
- A lot is a buy when its best few cards alone cover the lot price. The rest is profit.

Max to pay per card (35% return after eBay fees)

Card sells for	Pay no more than
$15	$8.96
$25	$15.30
$35	$21.64
$50	$31.15
$150	$94.56

Getting up to speed

1. **Weeks 1–2:** walk through lot reviews with Duane — parallels, checklists, pulling comps, the max-pay math.
2. **Weeks 3–4:** she starts buying to the rules. Lots over $500 get a quick check with Duane first.
3. **After that:** she buys on her own; a weekly look at hits and misses keeps both on the same page.

Where to look: eBay lots, the BucketCardz Discord, Facebook groups, and local card shows once she's ready.

Using Claude for a lot: paste the checklist or photos, ask it to flag the hits, pull comps, and run the max-pay math. Then match every comp photo to the actual card — parallels look alike.

Tools and access

Full access from day one. She gets her own login on each tool rather than Duane's — that's about clean accounts, not trust: her own two-factor, her own history, nothing breaks if a password changes.

Tool	What for	Access
Shopify (dfscards.com)	Theme, pages, products	Staff account, full access
Instagram @duanefurlongcards	Posting, DMs	Added via Meta Business Suite
Facebook	Page posting	Page admin
eBay Seller Hub (dfscards)	Comps, listings, orders	Multi-user access, full permissions
CardPulse	Logging lots, comps, pricing	Her own access code, full member (Operations tab included)
Claude	Posts, site copy, lot research	Her own seat, added to the Sports Cards project
BucketCardz Discord	Sourcing, market chatter	From the start
Canva or similar	Post templates	Shared brand kit with the crest and colors

Anything without user roles gets shared through LastPass.

First 30 days

By day 30: new site live, social posting 4x a week, and Taylor buying lots.

1. **Week 1:** logins set up. Study CardCollector2 and Wayne Collection. Audit Instagram. Walk through lot reviews with Duane.

2. **Week 2:** site mockup (menu + homepage) to Duane. First week of posts live.
3. **Week 3:** build the site changes. About and FAQ written. First lots bought.
4. **Week 4:** new site live. 2-week content calendar running. First weekly buy review.

Weekly check-in (30 min): site progress, last week's posts and what sold, paper-buy review, next week's plan.

What done looks like at 90 days

- Site sales and email signups tracked monthly and growing
- Social driving at least a few direct sales a week at lower fees than eBay
- Taylor sourcing lots on her own as a regular part of the week

Sources

- CardCollector2
- Wayne Collection
- dfscards.com